

Introduction

I have always wished that my computer would be as easy to use as my telephone. My wish has come true. I no longer know how to use my telephone.

Bjarne Stroustrup,
(Creator of the C++ Programming Language)

We have come a long way from the time when mobile phones were looked upon as items of luxury and were only found in the hands of gentlemen and ladies riding around in a Limo. Today, your local *chaiwala* has one and takes orders on it. In India, with its vast geographical expanse mobiles have become the single most important communication tool. Penetration levels have far exceeded that of colour television, landlines or computers which have been present over here for far longer durations.

The penetration and importance is reflected in the calling rates prevalent in the country, which are among the lowest in the world and hence enabling the *aam junta* to talk to their near and dear ones.

Talking about the present, today they have become *electronic gadgets* in your pocket, which morphs into your PMP, digital camera, your email client on the move or your navigation aid. Therefore, in the first section of this *Fast Track to your mobile phone*, we explore various phones by personality types and typical usage. In the next section, we continue with this theme and present you with some of the best mobile phone models available in the market today with a brief listing of their features and estimated street price. Also, we have mentioned the pros and cons of the each listed model for quick decision making. You will find everything covered from Nokia to Fly in terms of manufacturers and their flagship models.

Physical components alone don't show a lot as to what your phone is capable of, so we have covered the various platforms (operating systems/firmware) that are available and are in vogue with the customers. We have covered the Symbian platform